Jihad & Truce: one framework, two decisions

Mutahhari, A Survey into the Lives of the Infallible Imams · Chapter 2: Imam al-Hassan's Pacifism (Sessions 1–2)

DEEP READING · BOOK 02 · DERIVED TEACHING DIAGRAM

A teaching framework drawn from Mutahhari, not a ruling for modern conflicts

STAGE 1 · THE JIHAD FRAMEWORK — Is there a lawful ground to fight?

A conflict confronts the Imam, the leader of the Muslims

DEFENSIVE JIHAD

Is a non-Muslim enemy attacking Islamic land, lives, property or sanctuaries?

YES → **Defensive jihad**

Obligatory on every Muslim, man or woman, free or not. No Imam's permission needed.

e.g. an invader occupying a Muslim land

NO →

FIGHTING REBELS · Q 49:9 (1)

Is a Muslim faction in armed revolt against the lawful, sitting Imam?

YES →

ENJOINING GOOD (1)

Is the Imam instead protesting a ruler who violates Islam?

NO →

No ground to fight

Starting a war on non-Muslims who have not attacked needs the Imam or his deputy.

Antecedent jihad: adult, free men

YES →

> *These all resulted from the differences in their circumstances.*
>
> Mutahhari · Session 2

HOW TO READ THE TREE

- **Imam al-Hassan (a) · dark green · aftermath: poison**
- **Imam al-Husayn (a) · blood red · aftermath: bloodshed**
- Principle applied (answer YES)
- Principle did not apply (answer NO)
- Not on either path: the law, but not their case
- (1) Numbered badges link a box to the scorecard below

Colours mark each route, not a causal output of the tree.

STAGE 2 · THE TRUCE FRAMEWORK — Must we fight now, or is a truce lawful?

TRUCE · MUHAQQIQ'S TEST (3)

Is a lawful truce on offer: time-bound, protective terms, no demand for allegiance?

YES →

TRUCE · STRENGTH TEST (2)

Is the force loyal and strong enough to win without years of Muslim bloodshed?

YES → **Fight on**

Strong enough, and a truce gains nothing? Then a truce is not permissible.

'Ali at Siffin: the stronger Iraqi forces fought 18 months

NO → **TRUCE: al-Hassan steps aside**

Book and Sunnah, no successor, no cursing of 'Ali, safety for his followers, no allegiance.

Precedent: the Prophet at Hudaybiyyah (3)

NO →

DUTY TO RISE (4 5 6)

Have all three conditions for rising ripened?

- Allegiance is demanded
- The wrong is manifest and proven
- A prepared base calls him

YES → **RISE: al-Husayn refuses**

Allegiance demanded and refused. Kufah's 18,000 letters. 72 loyal companions. A protestor's honourable death.

An honourable stand, even unto death

NO → **Not yet: expose first**

The duty to rise is not 'produced' until the ruler's true face shows.

Al-Hassan's peace did exactly this for al-Husayn

THE SIX PRINCIPLES — HOW EACH ONE APPLIED TO EACH IMAM

THE THREE CONDITIONS FOR RISING (4–6): al-Hassan 0 of 3 · al-Husayn 3 of 3

	1 Sitting head of state?	2 Loyal, reliable force?	3 Lawful truce on offer?	4 Allegiance demanded?	5 Binding call from a prepared base?	6 Wrong manifest and proven?
Imam al-Hassan (a)	✓ Caliph in the seat: his death would be the caliphate's defeat	✗ Kufah split: chiefs bribed, desertions at Nukhaylah	✓ Signed blank page: time-bound, protective clauses	✗ None: the treaty required no pledge	✗ Kufah divided, hostile factions active	✗ Not yet: Mu'awiyah's written terms promised religious rule

Same law. Different circumstances.

Neither Imam changed the law. The circumstances changed the answer.

"Imam al-Hassan's peace prepared the grounds for Imam al-Husayn's uprising." · Mutahhari, Session 2